was away, I think in Calcutta, and I was in Allahabad ill with mumps! The *Discovery* delves deep into the sources- of India's national personality. Together, these books have moulded a whole generation of Indians and inspired persons from many other countries.

Books fascinated Jawaharlal Nehru. He sought out ideas.

He was extraordinarily sensitive to literary beauty. In his writings he aimed at describing his motives and appraisals as meticulously as possible. The purpose was not self-justification or rationalization, b u t to show the Tightness and inevitability of the actions and events in which he was a prime participant.

He was a luminous man and his writings reflected the radiance of his spirit.

The decision of the Jawaharlal Nehru Memorial F u n d to bring out a uniform edition of these three classics will be widely welcomed.

Indira Gandhi

New Delhi

4 November 1980

P R E F A C E